Dynamic Predictive Model for Growth of *Salmonella* Enteritidis in Egg Yolk

Gompertz Model with Modified Ratkowsky Secondary Model

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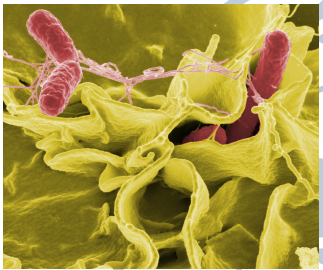
Introduction & Background

- *Salmonella* Enteritidis (SE) — leading cause of foodborne illness
- Shell eggs: SE penetrates shell $\rightarrow$ grows in iron-rich yolk
- USDA-FSIS: eggs stored $\leq 7.2\,^{\circ}\mathrm{C}$ within 12 h of laying
- Temperature fluctuates during cooling, storage, distribution
- **Objective:** Develop a dynamic Gompertz model for SE growth under sinusoidal temperature (3–43 °C)



Salmonella bacteria (colorized SEM). Source: NIAID/CDC, public domain.

Gumudavelli et al. (2007), *J. Food Sci.* 72:M254–62; Humphrey (1994), *Int J Food Microbiol* 21:31–40.

Model Description

Primary Model (Gompertz)

Constant T (analytical):

$$y(t) = A + C \cdot e^{-e^{(\mu e/C)(M-t)+1}}$$

Variable T (ODE):

$$\frac{dy}{dt} = -\mu(T)\, e\, \frac{y-A}{C}\, \ln\left(\frac{y-A}{C}\right)$$

$y = \log_{10} N$; A: initial; C: range; M: inflection time

Secondary Model (Ratkowsky)

$$\mu(T) = a(T - T_{\min})^2 \left(1 - e^{b(T - T_{\max})}\right)$$

a, b: regression coefficients

$T_{\min} = 6\,°\mathrm{C}$, $T_{\max} = 46.3\,°\mathrm{C}$ (fixed)

Dynamic Model

Integrate primary + secondary, solve numerically with `ode45`. Temperature interpolated via `interp1`.

Zwietering et al. (1991), *Appl Environ Microbiol* 57:1094–101; Baranyi & Roberts (1994), *Int J Food Microbiol* 23:277–94.

Data & Parameters

Data Summary

- Growth: 12 time points (0–17 hr), 20 observations
- 0–2 hr: single; 3–17 hr: duplicates
- Temperature: 47 points, sinusoidal ∼7–43 °C
- Interpolated via `interp1`

Param	Description	Guess	Status
A	Init. $\log_{10}$(CFU/mL)	2.60	Est.
C	Growth range	11	Est.
M	Inflection time (hr)	7.5	Est.
a	Ratkowsky coeff	3.38e-4	Est.
b	Ratkowsky coeff	0.275	Est.
$T_{\min}$	Min growth temp	6.0 °C	Fixed
$T_{\max}$	Max growth temp	46.3 °C	Fixed

Table 1. Model parameters and initial guesses.

Data source: Gumudavelli et al. (2007), Fig. 5c — sinusoidal temperature profile.

Forward Problem & Scaled Sensitivity Coefficients

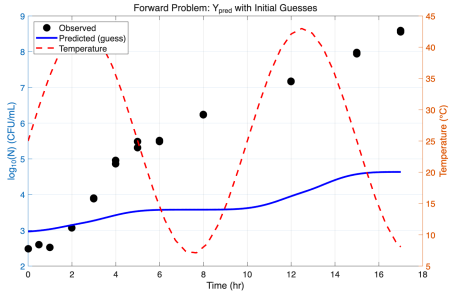


Fig. 1. Forward prediction with initial guesses.
Black: observed; Blue: predicted; Red: temperature.

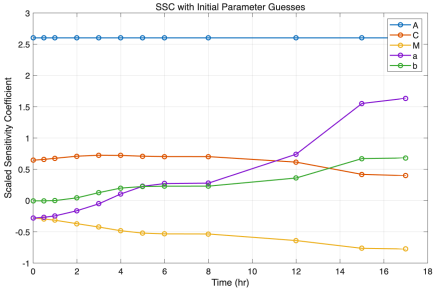


Fig. 2. Scaled sensitivity coefficients at initial guesses.
All 5 parameters show distinct patterns.

$T_{\min}$, $T_{\max}$ have negligible SSC $\rightarrow$ fixed at literature values.

SSC: $\mathrm{SSC}_{ij} = p_j \cdot \partial y_i / \partial p_j$; Beck & Arnold (1977), Ch. 5.

OLS Parameter Estimates

Param	Estimate	SE	Rel.Err (%)	$\mathrm{CI}_{\mathrm{lo}}$	$\mathrm{CI}_{\mathrm{hi}}$
A	2.4011	0.2540	10.58	1.8597	2.9425
C	6.3798	0.4565	7.16	5.4067	7.3528
M	2.9213	1.8074	61.87	−0.9310	6.7736
a	0.001135	0.000263	23.15	0.000575	0.001695
b	0.2621	0.2180	83.20	−0.2027	0.7268

Table 2. OLS parameter estimates with standard errors and 95% confidence intervals.

$\mathrm{RMSE} = 0.2524\ \log_{10}\ \mathrm{CFU/mL}$ $\quad$ Pseudo-$R^2 = 0.9874$ $\quad$ $\mathrm{MSE} = 0.0637$ $\quad$ $N = 20$

Estimated via MATLAB `nlinfit` (Levenberg–Marquardt); Beck & Arnold (1977).

Correlation Matrix

	A	C	M	a	b
A	1.000	−0.834	0.808	−0.281	0.459
C	−0.834	1.000	−0.711	0.050	−0.312
M	0.808	−0.711	1.000	−0.601	0.826
a	−0.281	0.050	−0.601	1.000	−0.930
b	0.459	−0.312	0.826	−0.930	1.000

Table 3. Parameter correlation matrix.

- Strong correlation between a and b (-0.930) — expected for Ratkowsky coefficients
- M and b also correlated (0.826) — lag time linked to temperature sensitivity
- High correlations may increase uncertainty but do not prevent estimation

Fitted Curve with Confidence & Prediction Bands

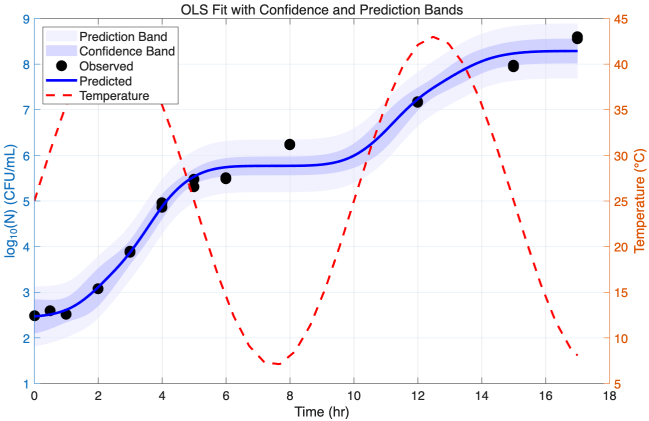


Fig. 3. OLS fitted curve with 95% asymptotic confidence band (dark) and prediction band (light). Black dots: observed; Blue: predicted; Red dashed: temperature.

CB and PB computed via MATLAB `nlpredci`; Gumudavelli et al. (2007).

Residual Analysis

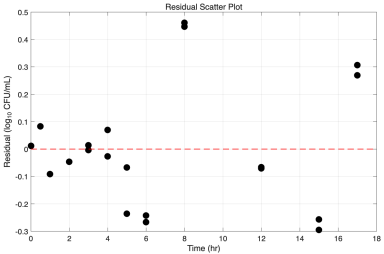


Fig. 4. Residuals vs. time.
Random scatter around zero.

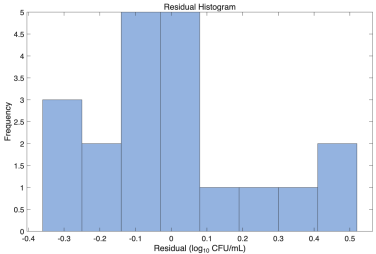


Fig. 5. Residual histogram.
Approximately bell-shaped.

#	Assumption	Result
1	Model is correct	✓ (visual)
2	Errors are random	DW $= 1.3149$
3	Constant variance	✓ (visual)
4	Errors uncorrelated	See DW
5	Normal distribution	SW $p = 1.0000$ (✓)

Table 4. Five standard statistical assumptions

Final Scaled Sensitivity Coefficients

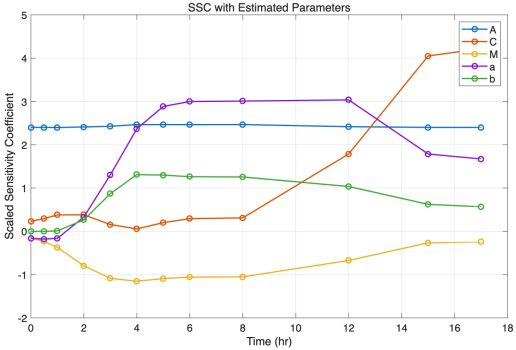


Fig. 6. SSC recomputed with estimated parameters. Patterns consistent with initial SSC.

Beck & Arnold (1977), p. 29–30.

Param	max|SSC|
A	2.4649
C	4.2172
M	1.1521
a	3.0349
b	1.3092

Table 5. Final SSC magnitudes.

All parameters identifiable at the OLS solution.

Optimal Experimental Design

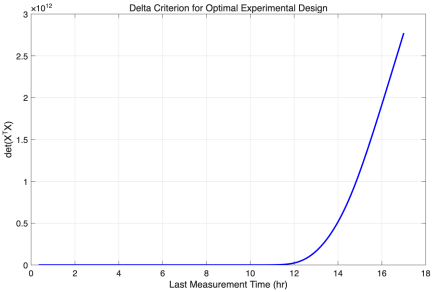


Fig. 7. Delta criterion $\det(X^T X)$ vs. last measurement time. Increasing: more data helps.

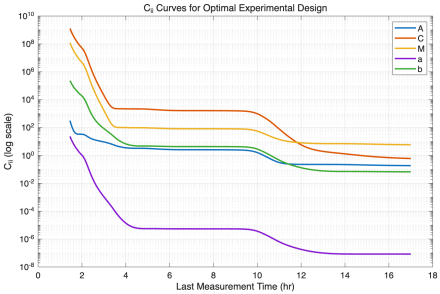


Fig. 8. C_{ii} curves (log scale). Decreasing: parameters become more precise.

Key measurement window: exponential growth phase (∼2–8 hr).

Beck & Arnold (1977), p. 419–443.

Bootstrap Analysis ($N = 1000$)

Param	Bootstrap CI Lower	Bootstrap CI Upper	Asymptotic CI Lower	Asymptotic CI Upper
A	1.600	2.741	1.860	2.943
C	5.761	7.819	5.407	7.353
M	-0.624	5.388	-0.931	6.774
a	8.81e-4	2.11e-3	5.75e-4	1.70e-3
b	0.065	—	-0.203	0.727

Table 6. Bootstrap vs. asymptotic 95% CI.

Band	Avg Width
Asymptotic CB	0.5307
Bootstrap CB	0.4058
Asymptotic PB	1.2042
Bootstrap PB	1.0720

Table 7. Band width comparison.

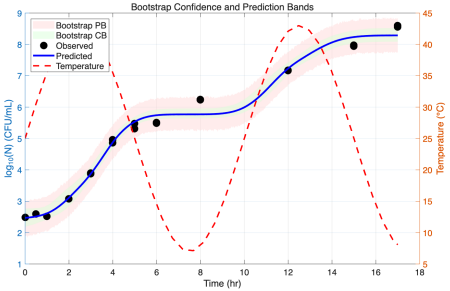


Fig. 9. Bootstrap CB (green) and PB (pink) from 1000 residual-resampling iterations.

Residual resampling bootstrap; Beck & Arnold (1977).

Summary & Conclusions

- Dynamic Gompertz model successfully developed for SE growth in egg yolk
- 5 parameters estimated, 2 fixed; RMSE $= 0.2524$ $\log_{10}$ CFU/mL
- Pseudo-$R^2 = 0.9874$; all 5 statistical assumptions evaluated
- Optimal experimental design: key window at 2–8 hr
- Bootstrap CIs generally consistent with asymptotic CIs
- **Practical significance:** Model predicts SE risk during egg cooling, storage, and distribution — supports USDA-FSIS 7.2 °C recommendation

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Thank You!

Questions?